

The world has changed.

What once required a small *IT department* can now be managed by *one person*.

TWO YEARS AGO <i>team</i> <i>required to ship anything real</i> — harvesting data — engineers + a pipeline — dashboards — analysts + BI tooling — workflows — a backend, a queue, a roadmap — maps, auth, OCR, search — each its own project	NOW <i>one person</i> <i>working evenings, with patience and judgment</i> + harvest opaque data — OCR, scrape, parse + build dashboards in an afternoon + wire end-to-end workflows with audit trails + maps, auth, PDF readers — commodity components
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*The tooling that belonged to a small engineering org ten years ago now sits on **any individual's** desk.*

OCR, vector search, language models, maps, hosting, auth, audit logs — all commoditized. A retired tech manager working alone can now ship the kind of thing that used to mean a hire, a budget, and a quarter of meetings.

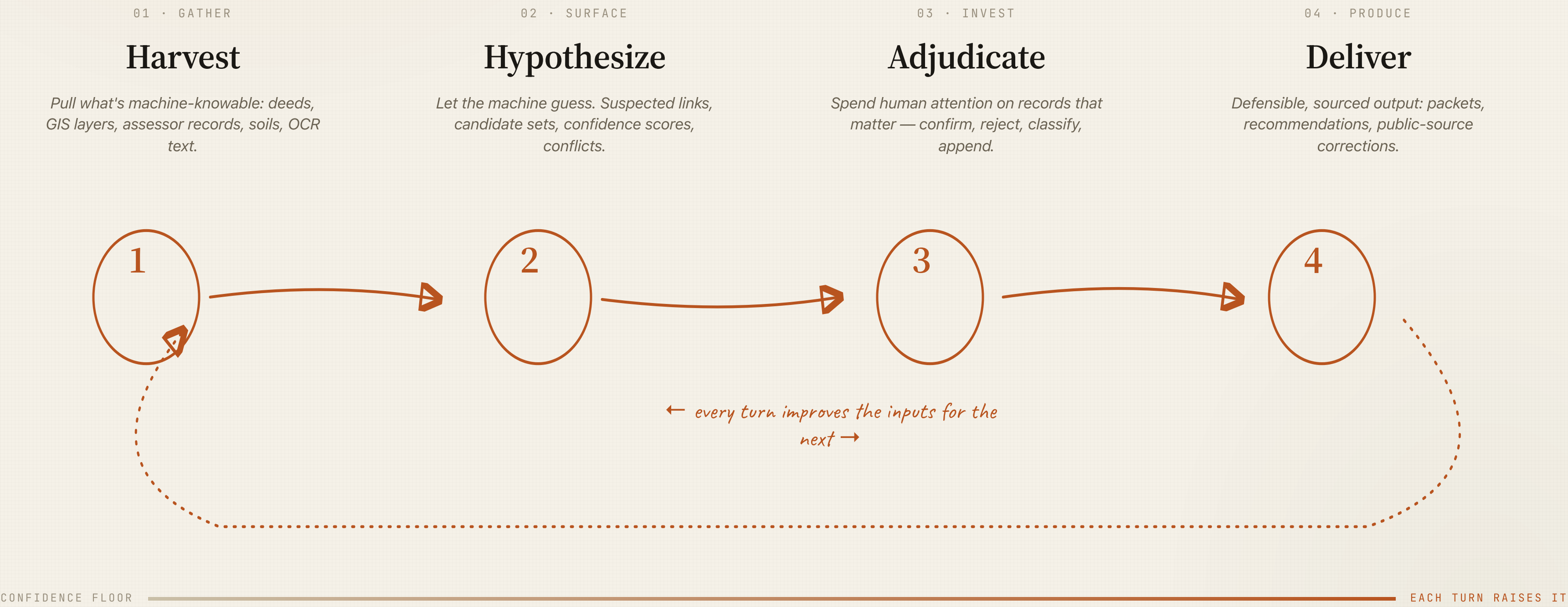
And these tools keep getting **sharper underneath us**. Today's capabilities are a floor, not a ceiling — they improve without the operator rebuilding anything.

For DCLT specifically: over 10,000 registry documents that no one was ever going to read by hand are now downloaded, OCR'd, searchable, and joinable to parcels. Evidence, not paper.

One honest caveat. *Hand-written cursive from the 1800s will stay opaque for a while yet. We design assuming the older fraction of the corpus stays in the "a person has to read it" bucket — and bet that the bucket shrinks each year.*

The work is a *loop*.

Each turn, the machine guesses harder questions and the humans answer the ones worth answering. Confidence accumulates.



The constraint *moved*.

A finished-looking prototype is easy to mistake for a finished idea. Don't.

WAS — THE QUESTION WE USED TO ASK

~~What's technically possible?~~

- Can we OCR these documents at all?
- Can we link deeds to parcels reliably?
- Can we host a real portal with auth?
- Can we layer GIS data, render a map?
- Can we keep an audit trail credible enough for a town meeting?

IS — THE QUESTION WE HAVE TO ANSWER NOW

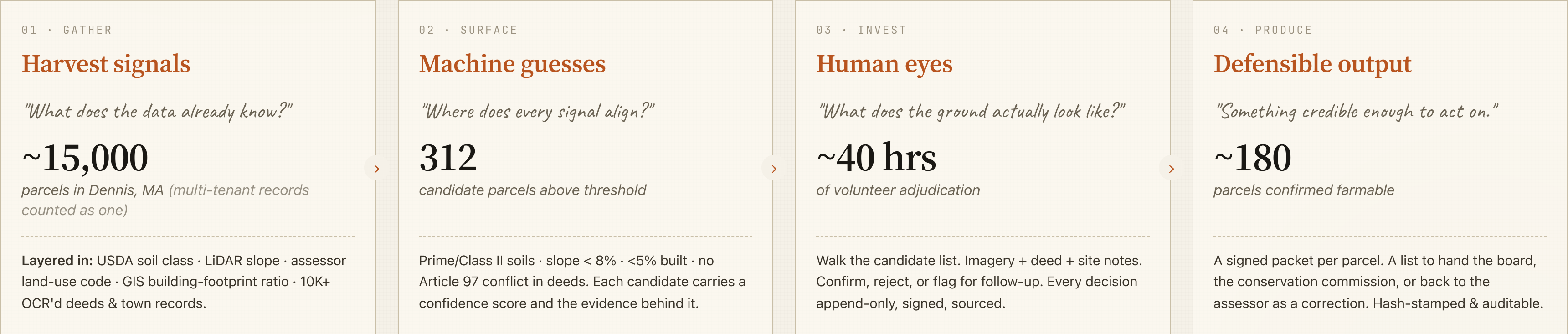
What is *worth* doing with it?

- + Whose work do we make easier — Dave's, a volunteer's, the board's?
- + Object-oriented, activity-oriented, role-oriented — or something else?
- + Where do we invest human attention, and where do we trust the machine?
- + What outputs are credible enough to change minds at the assessor's office?
- + What's a year-one win worth shipping vs. a "someday" feature?

Read the prototype as a vocabulary, not a proposal. *It exists to make the forks legible — so that disagreeing with it is cheaper than designing it. The most useful thing you can do with it is tell me what's wrong.*

One question, walked through the loop: *which Dennis parcels are farmable?*

The same shape works for Article 97 status, conservation value, ownership history. This is just the one we'll use to ground the conversation.



↻ **And the loop closes.** Each adjudication strengthens the training signal under the next pass. Reject patterns surface OCR errors. Confirmed deeds become high-quality evidence for related parcels. Next year's "farmable" run starts from a better floor.

*So – when we open the prototype, ask: does it surface **parcels** first, or **tasks** first, or **your role** first?*